



IN BRIEF

BREAKING THE RULES

The 1920s were a time of social liberation for many women, who began to dress and behave in ways that celebrated their newfound freedom.

1900

- **1920** The 18th Amendment is ratified in the US, outlawing the manufacture and sale of intoxicating liquors; the 19th Amendment is ratified in the US, granting (white) women the vote.
- **1923** The Matrimonial Causes Act is passed in the UK, making grounds for divorce the same for husband and wife.
- **1923** Alice Paul, head of the National Women's Party, proposes the Lucretia Mott Amendment calling for equal rights for men and women.
- **1923** The Charleston dance craze sweeps across the US.
- **1924** Marie C. Brehm becomes the first female candidate to run legally for the vice-presidency of the US.
- **1925** Josephine Baker moves to France, where she becomes a sensation following her debut at the Folies Bergère.
- **1926** Coco Chanel designs the little black dress.
- **1927** The first talking movie, *The Jazz Singer*, is released, starring Mary Dale as a dancer.
- **1928** The Olympic Games allow women to contend in athletics and gymnastics.
- **1928** All women over the age of 21 get the vote in the UK under the Representation of the People Act.
- **1929** The Flapper Election in the UK—the first general election in which all women can vote—results in a huge turnout.
- **1929** The *Edwards vs. Canada* lawsuit acknowledges women as “qualified persons” and thus eligible to sit in the Senate in Canada.
- **1929** The US stock market crashes, signaling the beginning of the Great Depression in the West.
- **1930** German actress Marlene Dietrich has her big break playing the cabaret singer Lola-Lola in *The Blue Angel*.

◀ **TWO FLAPPERS DANCE ON THE ROOFTOP OF A CHICAGO HOTEL, 1926.**

